

Math 131: Complex Analysis

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Problem 1. Please tell me a bit about your analysis background. For example, which Dartmouth courses have you taken? What courses have you taken elsewhere and what did they cover? In particular, what multivariable calculus have you had? Have you ever taken an (undergraduate) complex variables course such as our Math 43?

Solution.

I took Math 63 last term. Before that, I did single-variable calculus in high school, but I haven't formally taken multivariable calculus. Over the break I've been self-studying the basics and trying to get some footing before this course.

I haven't taken an undergraduate complex analysis course.

Problem 2. What are you hoping to get out of this course? "I'm only here because I have to take a classroom course and this was the best option" is an acceptable but disappointing answer. Of course, I am hoping for more.

Solution.

I mainly want to develop a clearer understanding of what analysis actually is and what kinds of problems it studies. Math 63 gave me some exposure, but I spent most of the term adjusting to the style of thinking, so I'm hoping this course helps me build more fluency.

Problem 3. What is your attitude towards analysis? Again, “I hope to never had to take or teach an analysis course again” is acceptable. But so is, “I hope to work in analysis someday”.

Solution.

I’m still figuring out my attitude towards analysis. I’ve taken more algebra, so analysis feels less natural to me and sometimes like I have to rewire my instincts. At the same time, it is incredibly satisfying when things finally click.

Problem 4. If you are willing, tell me something interesting about yourself. For example, I came to Dartmouth in the fall of 1985. For a time, I was interested in underwater photography, but I can’t dive anymore so I’ve moved on to photos above water.

Solution.

I practiced martial arts for about nine years, including four years of competitive boxing and kickboxing. I have fallen out of practise since coming to Dartmouth but I hope to get back into it (if only for PE credit).